

Q.3b (15 marks): Culture as extra corporal behaviour dependent on biological preconditioning

"Culture as extra corporal behaviour of man is dependent on the biological preconditioning."
Discuss. 15

Culture as defined by Herskovits is the "man made part of environment".

As environment influences biology, thus biology also impact cultural expressions.

Culture : dependent on biological preconditioning

① Bipedalism: led to freeing of ~~the~~ hands resulting in tool development & usage.

② Early birth & premature babies: acted as a handicap for women, thus required help of other (usually male companion). This led to the evolution of institution of marriage.

* Early birth also necessitated longer socialisation process thus enabling transmission of ~~one~~ culture from one generation to another!

उम्मीदवारों को इस दृष्टि में नहीं लिखना चाहिए
Candidates must not write on this margin

③ Development of Broca area & thyroid bone complex : allowed vocal expression & development of language

③ MAOA⁺ gene study by Caspi et al.
↳ highlight its role in making individual violent thus affecting culture

However, this view of biological determinism of culture is not completely accurate and led to emergence of scientific racism.

↳ Thomas Jefferson's view that negroes do not require rest

↳ Charles Darwin pointing the lack of innovation in Africa to lower mental capacity of negroes.

Thus, view emerged that countered this.

a) Mead's Study "Coming of age in Samoa"

↳ highlighted the difference in cultural practices ~~due to~~ & behaviour of adolescent girls due to culture & not biology.

b) Eric Turkheimer's study on 10

highlighted that genes play only some role initially, however an enabling environment also has a role to play.

Thus, Turkheimer has pointed that 'everything has turned out to be somewhat heritable yet nothing turned out to be completely heritable.